Your First Week: Organizing Mom's Care Needs for a Professional Review

Nine actions, in order, with a line for who does each and by when.

The goal for the week: you can hand a professional a clear, dated picture of what Mom does on her own, where she gets help, what information you have, and which questions are still open.

Share the list. Put a name and a day next to each action, and tick it when it's done.

ACTION	WHO	BY WHEN	DONE
1. Gather the latest discharge and care instructions, and anything else you were given in writing.			
2. Ask Mom what she feels she can do and where help is useful. Write down what she says.			
3. Note what she does on her own this week and where someone helps: bathing, dressing, eating, using the bathroom, moving around.			
4. Write down how she gets around the house and what she uses to stand, sit and move between bed and chair.			
5. Write down what you've noticed about memory, mood or how she communicates, as what you saw.			
6. List your medication questions for the prescriber or the pharmacist. Change nothing.			
7. Note any concerns about eating, swallowing, continence or skin for a professional to look at.			
8. List the therapies or services already involved, with their dates.			
9. Next to each open question, write who it goes to: the doctor, the nurse, the pharmacist, the therapist or a care consultant.			

You're done when

What Mom can do now, the help she already gets, where your information came from and your open questions are all written down, each question with a name beside it. What comes after that, the review itself and any decision about care, isn't on this list, because it isn't the family's to do alone.

If the week goes sideways

- Don't fill a gap by guessing. “We don't know yet” is a finished line.

- If you see something the discharge papers told you to watch for, don't wait for the end of the week. Call the number you were given.

What this plan doesn't do

It organizes your part. It doesn't certify that Mom is safe, decide what care she needs, or stand in for the professional review it prepares you for.

Ready for the next step?

You've spent a week organizing what you know. The care interview goes through Mom's situation area by area with you, so nothing important is overlooked, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›